

FORM FOUR MIDTERM EXAMINATION

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

wazaelimu.com

Time: 3 Hours

March 2026

INSTRUCTIONS

1. This paper consists of sections A, B and C with a total of ten (10) questions.
2. Answer all questions in section A and B and only two questions in section C.
3. Write your examination number on every page of your answer sheet.
4. All writings must be in blue or black ink.

SECTION A (15 Marks)

Answer all questions in this section

1. Choose the most correct answer among the following alternative and write its letter in the answer booklet(s).
 - (i) A puzzle statement that is set in order for someone to discover a hidden meaning is called.....
 - A. Saying
 - B. Proverb
 - C. Riddle
 - D. Tongue twister
 - (ii) I am reading a short story. There is a main character called Hyena who is greedy and never listens to the advice of other characters. Finally, I have received a message that people should listen to the good advice of others. What kind of story am I reading?
 - A. Legend
 - B. Fable
 - C. Myth
 - D. Folktale
 - (iii) Literature is presented in two forms, namely.....
 - A. Oral form and spoken form
 - B. Narration and dialogue form
 - C. Form and content
 - D. Written form and Oral form
 - (iv) One of the following is not a feature of oral Literature;
 - A. It is cheap
 - B. It has no specific setting
 - C. It has many genres
 - D. It is presented orally
 - (v) A kind of song that is sung during a burial or funeral is called.....

- A. Dirge
 - B. Chant
 - C. Lullaby
 - D. War song
- (vi)refers to the arrangement of events in a work of art.
- A. Satire
 - B. Imagery
 - C. Plot
 - D. Sarcasm
- (vii) Which of the following is an effect of science and technology on oral literature?
- A. It becomes cheap
 - B. It becomes old
 - C. No feedback
 - D. It has not changed the mode of presentation
- (viii) A wise or philosophical statement that is used to express a general truth or give advice is called.....
- A. Idiom
 - B. Riddle
 - C. Proverb
 - D. Saying
- (ix) A product of human creativity, or a skill and technique used to create things, is called.....
- A. Plot B. Setting C. Art D. Language
- (x) A song that is sung to soothe children or help a baby sleep is called.....:
- A. Lullaby song B. Humour C. Dirge D. Chant

2. Match the items in column A with those in column B to make the meaningful sentences by writing the letter of the correct response below the corresponding item in table provided.

Column A	Column B
(i) Legends (ii) Chant (iii) Anecdote (iv) Myth (v) Folktale	A. It is a short story handed down in spoken form from one generation to the next. B. A story that narrates about the origin of things. C. A prayer song that is sung for religious purposes. D. Short amusing story about real people or events. E. They are stories that present characters of high position

SECTION B (40 Marks)

Answer **all** questions in this section

3. Define the following literary terms:

- (i) Literature
- (ii) Title
- (iii) Language
- (iv) Idiom
- (v) Setting

4. Briefly explain five (5) functions of Literature to the society.

5. With vivid examples, briefly explain the following literary concepts;

- (i) Written literature
- (ii) Social realities
- (iii) Short stories
- (iv) Oral literature
- (v) Imagination

6. Asia is in form three this year. She is having a hard time opting for Literature in English because it is a new subject. How can you convince her to choose that subject? Use only five points.

SECTION C (45 Marks)

Answer three (3) questions from this section.

7. Literature and society are inseparable. Discuss by giving out five points.

8. 'Literature and language are two sides of the same coin.' Discuss this statement by using five points.

9. 'Oral literature is greatly affected by the development of science and technology.'
Prove this statement using six points.

10. With vivid examples, discuss six genres of oral literature.